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Sprint is suing to try and prevent the proposed AT&T and T-Mobile merger
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There's just so much new here that we have to list it in points:

- Proper multi-monitor support! Each screen can now have its own taskbar that can show all apps or only the apps running on that screen. In fact, Windows even comes with a theme that carries a dual-screen wallpaper just for multi-monitor users. The Metro UI can only work on one screen at a time, but you can switch between multiple screens at any time.
- Explorer has a new ribbon-based UI. Love it or hate it, it's there; and in our opinion it is quite functional. With the loss of menus in Windows Vista, this UI brings back many useful operations that we missed. It can always be collapsed and ignored.
- The ribbon UI can show context and content-sensitive tools such as 'pinning' apps and 'running as adminis-

- A detailed view will show a graph of changes in speed over time
- The UI for resolving conflicts is much improved
- There's a new "Automatic" option for Aero window colour, which automatically selects the colour of the window borders based on the wallpaper colour. If your wallpaper is set to a slide show, your Aero window colours will change with each change of wallpaper.
- There's a new task manager that, in its detailed view, is very powerful. You can see not only how much CPU and memory each application is consuming, but also its network utilisation and other attributes. The new task manager is very detailed.

Windows 8 core features

A number of features in Windows 8 change the core of the Windows experience. One major addition is that of inbuilt cloud syncing. You might notice it the first time you set up your user account, when Windows asks you to enter your Windows Live credentials. You can use your Windows Live account instead of a local account (which too is an option), and in that case, some of your settings etc. will be automatically synced to the web and other computers associated with the same login. This is quite similar to Chrome OS, which does the same with Google accounts.

Another great example is the new File history feature. Volume shadow copy / system restore from Windows XP was improved in Windows Vista with a "Previous Version" option to retrieve old versions of files. Windows 8 takes it further by building a proper UI around it, allowing you to browse the history of your data folders and restore previous versions of your library folders at any time. All of your libraries are automatically backed up. You can now even select where to store these previous versions of files; even network locations can be selected, and you can offer your computer's storage to others in your HomeGroup.

Windows 8 now also offers an option to "Refresh" the Windows install, which will reload all Windows files without touching your personal data. In this case, the same setting will be reverted to and



Through the taskbar configuration you can have the taskbar appear on all monitors, and can configure which apps to display on each taskbar

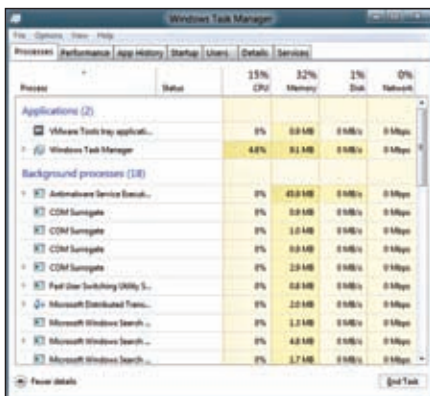
your applications will need to be reinstalled (not the ones installed from the Windows Store though). Another option is to "Reset" your install, which instead removes all personal data from the computer so you can resell it.

Anti-virus technology is also inbuilt in Windows 8, and includes the new SmartScreen filter that was introduced in IE 9. Now, files downloaded using any browser will be checked by Windows against an online malware database.

Another core improvement in Windows 8 is in how it shuts down and boots up. Now, even on shutting down, Windows hibernates its core processes so they can launch that much faster next time. This can lead to some serious improvements in boot speed.

There are numerous improvements in Windows 8; even the Blue Screen of Death has been changed to a less threatening emoticon-laced design. There are many things to hate and as many to love. But this is just a hint of what Windows 8 is, though released mostly for developers.

Yes, the Windows 8 Developer is not complete; it's not even a beta, but a pre-beta. While all we've mentioned here is available in the Developer Preview build – and you can check it for yourself, it's on the DVD – take it all with a grain of salt. The final version of Windows 8 will most likely improve many things and possibly even remove some features. **d**



The new process manager is very detailed. This is just one of the tabs

- trator' for exe files, extraction options for zip files, mounting and burning options for ISO files etc.
- Common operations can be pinned to the Windows Explorer toolbar.
- An up button is situated next to the back and forward button to move to a folder's parent.
- Yes, Windows 8 can now mount ISO and VHD files without any third-party software. Oh what joy!
- The copy-and-move interface is revamped so that:
 - All file transfer operations appear in the same window
 - These operations can be paused